

whether the application is working fine and delivering what is expected.

Server uptime records

One of the most important factors while selecting a hosting service provider is the server uptime record. A server uptime record of 99.5 per cent or above is recommended. Anything below that is unacceptable. One can obtain this record in a number of ways. For one, you can check the latest uptime score of any hosting service provider. In addition, the Web host can be tracked with several server monitoring tools.

Multiple add-on domains

Having multiple domain names is the most common thing these days, simply because domain names are affordable. But to host these domain names, one needs extra hosting space. This is why it is important to have a hosting account that allows hosting of multiple domains. Most of the hosting companies allow hosting of up to 25 add-on domains, but we recommend you be doubly sure about what exactly is on offer before you actually make the investment.

Server upgrade options

While you can begin hosting your website or application on a shared hosting basis, you should always check if

there is room for upgradation when your traffic shoots up. By growth, we mean upgrading of the Web service, from shared to dedicated hosting—for more compute power, disk storage, memory capacity and security features.

Renewal prices

Shared hosting is very cheap. But hosting providers tend to charge more when customers approach them for renewals. Before entering into a contract with any service provider, an IT decision-maker must check the TOS (Terms Of Service) and find out the renewal cost, to avoid unpleasant surprises later on.

Refund policy

Even after you have checked all these aspects, you still might not like certain things about your hosting provider's service. So it is important to check the refund policy. Questions that need to be answered are: Will the company refund the entire money if you choose to cancel the host within the trial period? What is the refund policy if you want to withdraw after the trial sessions?

You must know how you will get your refund if something doesn't work out. Some companies charge a lot in case of cancellation of the contract, while others provide an 'anytime money back' guarantee. The first variety should be avoided at all costs.

SOME OPTIONS TO CHOOSE FROM

ESDS Software Solution Pvt Ltd

ESDS started operations in 2005, and has since made rapid strides as an established group of Web hosting companies and fully managed data centres based in India, UK and USA. The company specialises in provisioning high quality managed hosting, managed servers, server racks and cages, co-location and systems security, cloud hosting, data centre management systems, etc.

Today, 10 years down the line, the firm has more than 35,000 customers worldwide, a significant amount of them being corporate entities whose businesses depend on their Internet presence. ESDS is a CMMI Level 3 company, a NASSCOM member, and a SAP-certified data centre and cloud hosting provider.

Major Linux-based offerings: eNlight Cloud, eMagic



(a data centre management suite), MTvScan (a malware, Trojan and vulnerability scanner), etc.

Open source tools used: PHP, MySQL, Perl, Hadoop, Apache, Exim, Lester, Magento, Zimbra, etc.

USP: In-house R&D team, an exuberant support team, many industry-first innovations, managed services expertise, fully conceptualised and developed enterprise products and solutions like those mentioned above.

Website: www.esds.co.in